

Amendment No. 3 to HB1784

Behn
Signature of Sponsor

AMEND Senate Bill No. 1940

House Bill No. 1784*

by deleting "; now therefore," at the end of the final clause of the preamble and substituting "; and".

AND FURTHER AMEND by inserting the following immediately after the final clause of the preamble:

WHEREAS, since Tennessee's near-total abortion ban took effect, women in this State have been denied medically necessary health care, including treatment for miscarriages, ectopic pregnancies, and life-threatening conditions; and

WHEREAS, Tennessee physicians have reported leaving this State or ceasing to practice obstetrics due to fear of criminal prosecution, worsening the State's existing maternal healthcare crisis; and

WHEREAS, Tennessee has one of the highest maternal mortality rates in the nation, and restrictions on reproductive health care have been shown to increase maternal death; and

WHEREAS, the unalienable rights recognized in our nation's founding document include the right of living women to life, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness; and

WHEREAS, a day of observance is unable to substitute for the health care, support, and dignity that Tennessee women and families deserve; now, therefore,